particular group? As we have seen, Badiou seems to think so and this represents the primary reason he looks to Paul as a model, for it was the Apostle who sought to overcome the election of the Jews by making salvation available to all through Christ. Badiou thus seeks to perform the secular (*laïque*) equivalent of Paul's gesture of religious supersession.

But this, according to Marty, constitutes a misreading, for Paul always saw himself as a Jew and always thought that salvation came through the Jews. For Paul, the sacrifice of Christ was a repetition of the binding of Isaac by Abraham, an "event" that Badiou passes over in his attempt to make the word "Jew" devoid of any meaning besides what Hitler attached to it. Paul said there is "neither Jew nor Greek," but he also said immediately after: "And if you are Christ's, then you are Abraham's offspring, heirs according to promise." As Marty explains, the universality declared by Paul is "in no manner the bourgeois declaration of the rights of man," nor is it a declaration that the abstract individual, devoid of all particularity, would be "the measure or standard of the universal."[18] Paul, moreover, did not renounce his belonging to a particular people. "I myself am an Israelite, a descendant of Abraham, a member of the tribe of Benjamin," Paul wrote in the Epistle to the Romans (11:1). As Marty explains, following in the tradition of Jewish thinkers like Emmanuel Levinas, Jews (including Paul) have their own version of the universal that passes through the singularity, and the particularity, of the Jewish people.[19]

I would like to suggest that a similar notion of the universal, not rigidly opposed to the particular, can also be found within the French intellectual tradition. I believe that it was really during the Dreyfus Affair and its aftermath that the battle lines between the universal and the particular hardened into the fundamentally opposed camps that we know today. The 1905 separation of church and state, a consolidation of the victory of the Dreyfusards over the Barrèsian and Maurrassian right, helped to consolidate a vision of the secular public sphere that could not accommodate minority religious or ethnic identities. Secularism or *laïcité* came to equal the absence of religion or ethnicity.[20] Prior to the Dreyfus Affair, however, this was not really the case. What Jean Baubérot calls the first stage of *laïcité* meant the equal treatment of France's three major religious groups (Catholics, Protestants, and Jews) by the state.[21] It was according to this logic that the government sponsored religious schools and paid the salaries of the clergy (including, after 1831, rabbis) until 1905. This was not in contradiction to universalism but rather its fullest implementation because the goal was to treat the religions equally, not to banish them to the private realm. The notion

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